

01
Maps and inequalities

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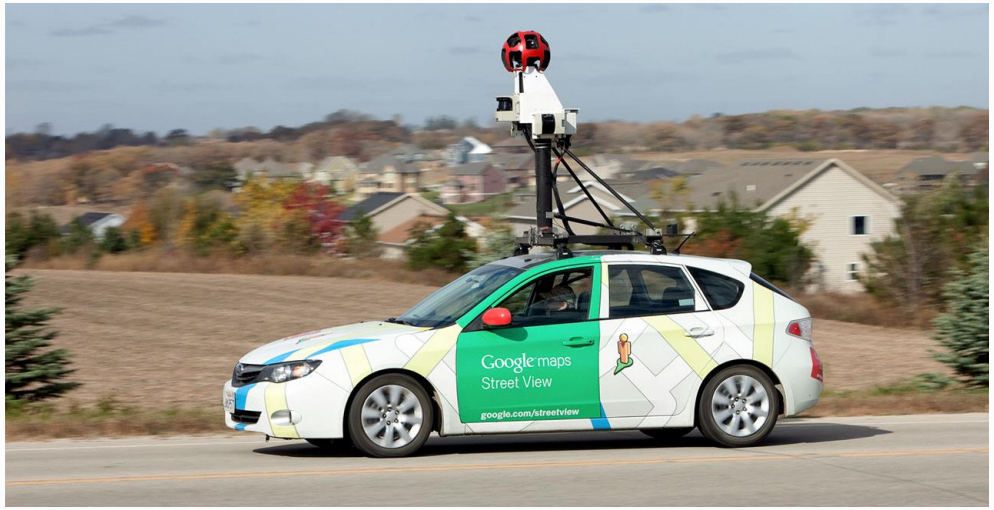
UNIVERSITY OF WARWICK

Maps, cartography: Understanding key concepts

Map

Geodesy

Is what figuring out where things are and how to record them. Focus is on *mathematical foundations* (coordinates, Earth's shape).



This was once a **huge scientific enterprise**, today this is done by satellite and most of us, even very specialist geographers don't have to think about it very much.
Keywords: precision, geolocation, GPS, LIDAR, coordinates system…

Cartography

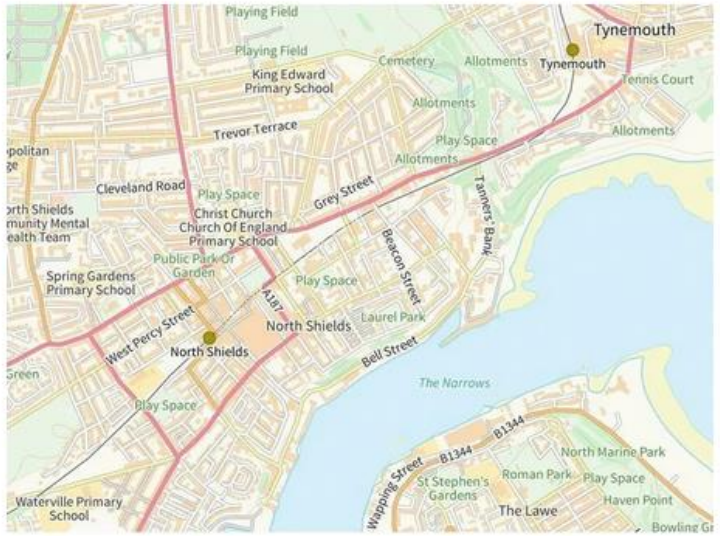
Is how we *visualize* information about *things* in the world on maps.



The history of cartography is long and detailed, and **the question of what was mapped by whom** has dramatically shaped the modern world.
Keywords: projections, shapes, size, colour…

Who makes maps?

Governments

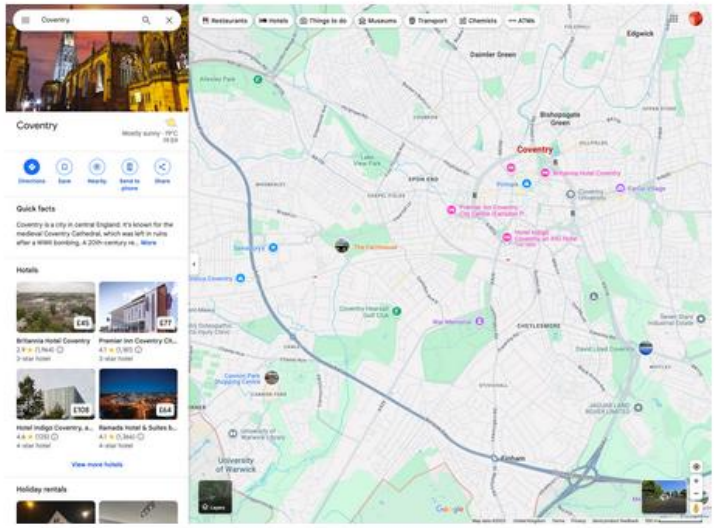


Motivation: public service

Official maps

- Ordnance Survey
- NASA

Companies

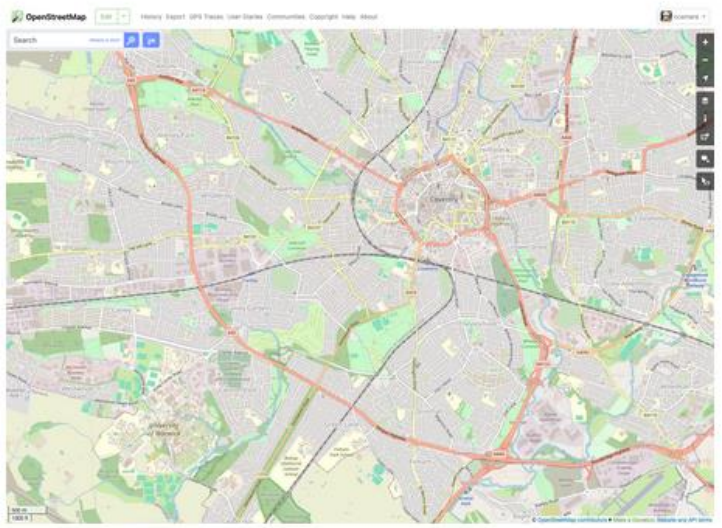


Motivation: Business model.

- Google, Microsoft, Apple…
- ESRI, Carto
- …

Specific, detailed maps, related to their business model.

Individuals!

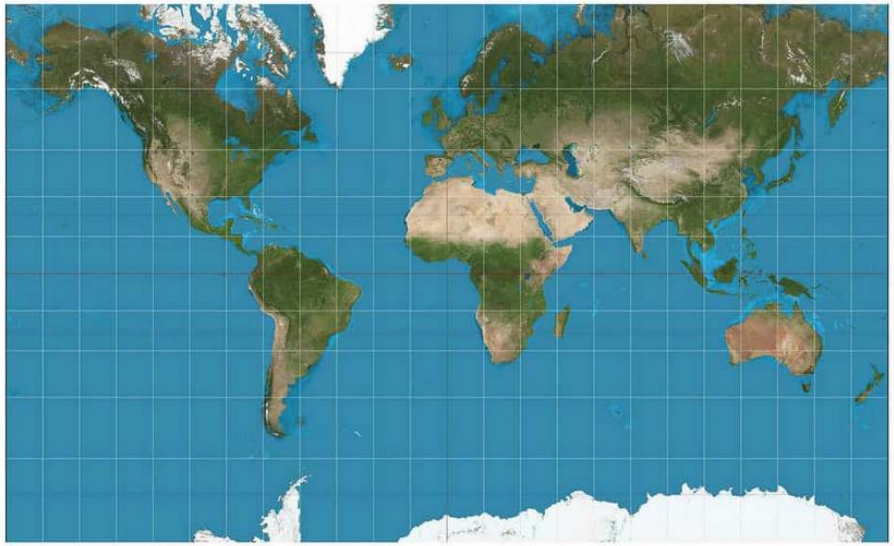


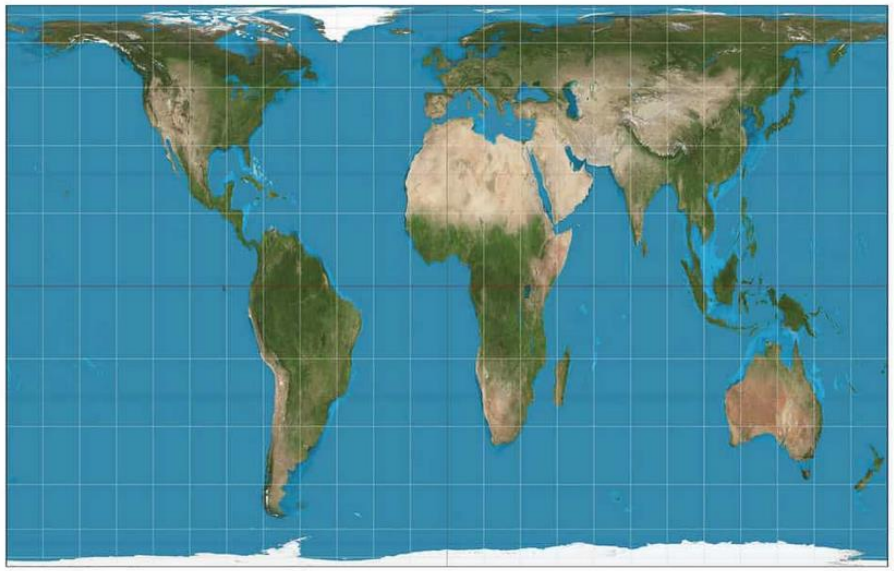
Motivation: diverse Coverage and precision: diverse

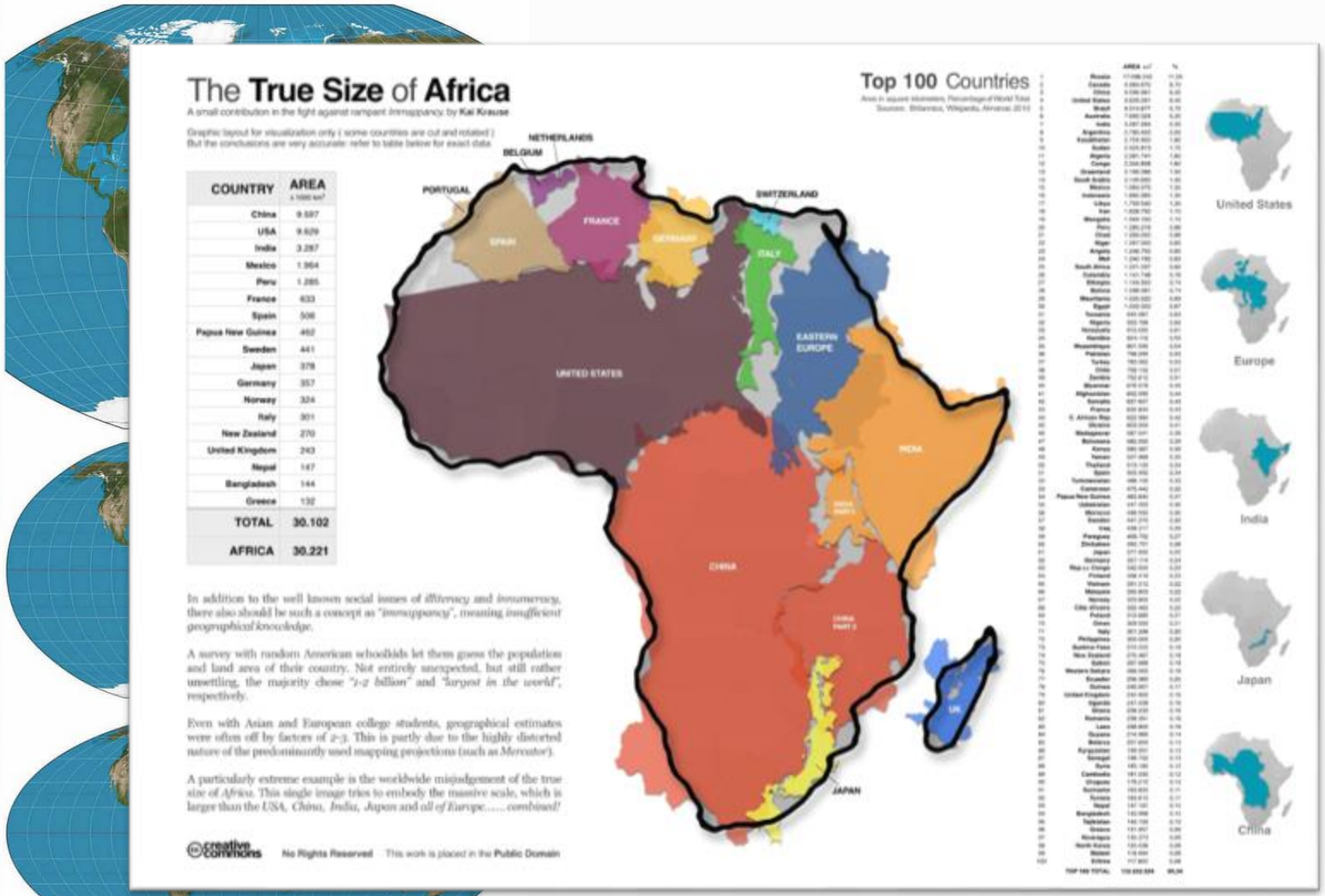
- OpenStreetMap, “the wikipedia of the maps”
- …

Maps are about decisions

Creating a map involves a series of decisions that are anything but objective

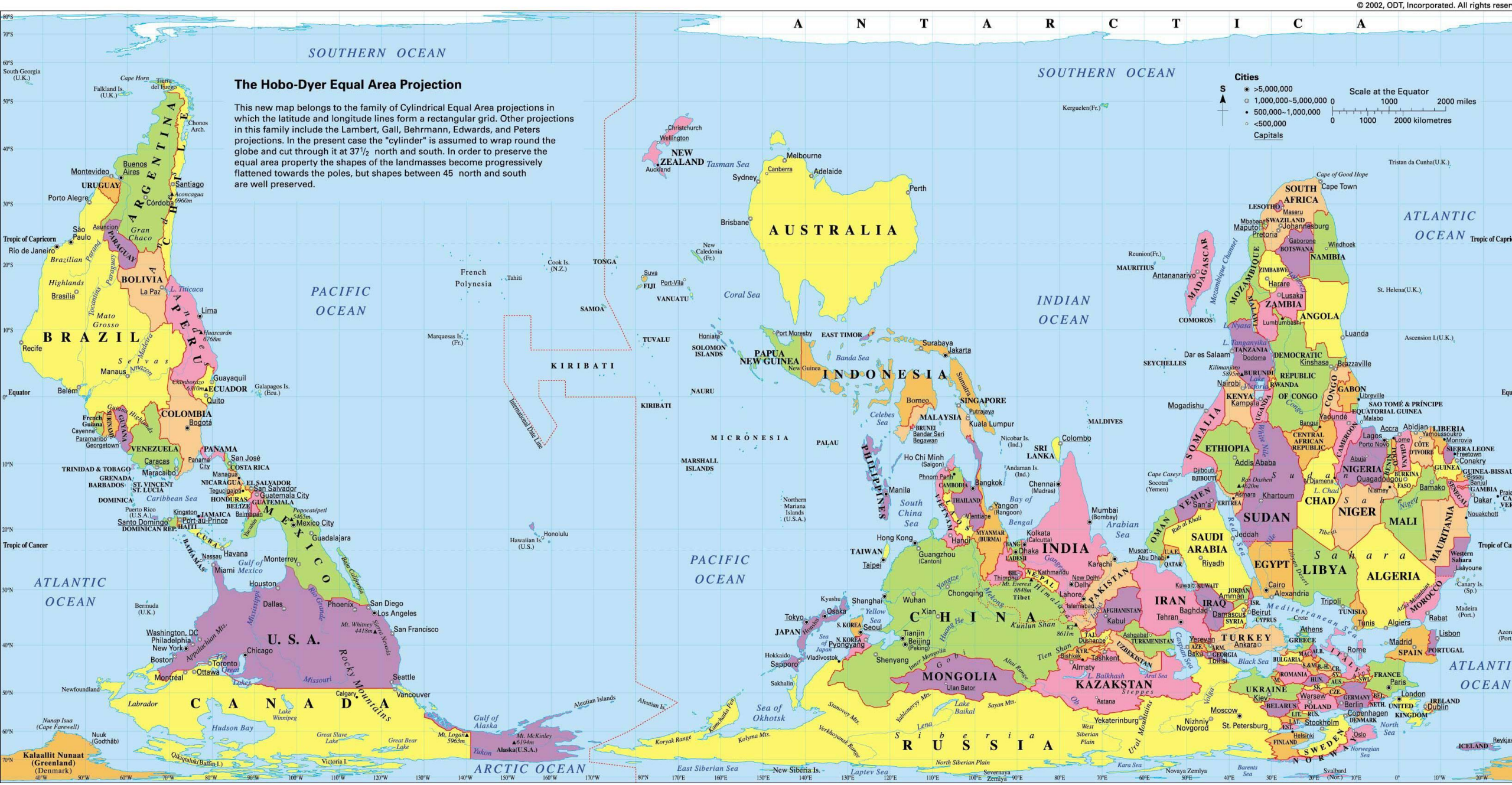






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Maps are political!

...even Trump knows that



Maps: more than technical, objective artifacts

There's a long history of maps and power (Harley, 1988)

- Maps have a political agenda (Crampton, 2009)
- Used for domination and control ( ), surveillance (Foucault, 1977; Crampton, 2009)

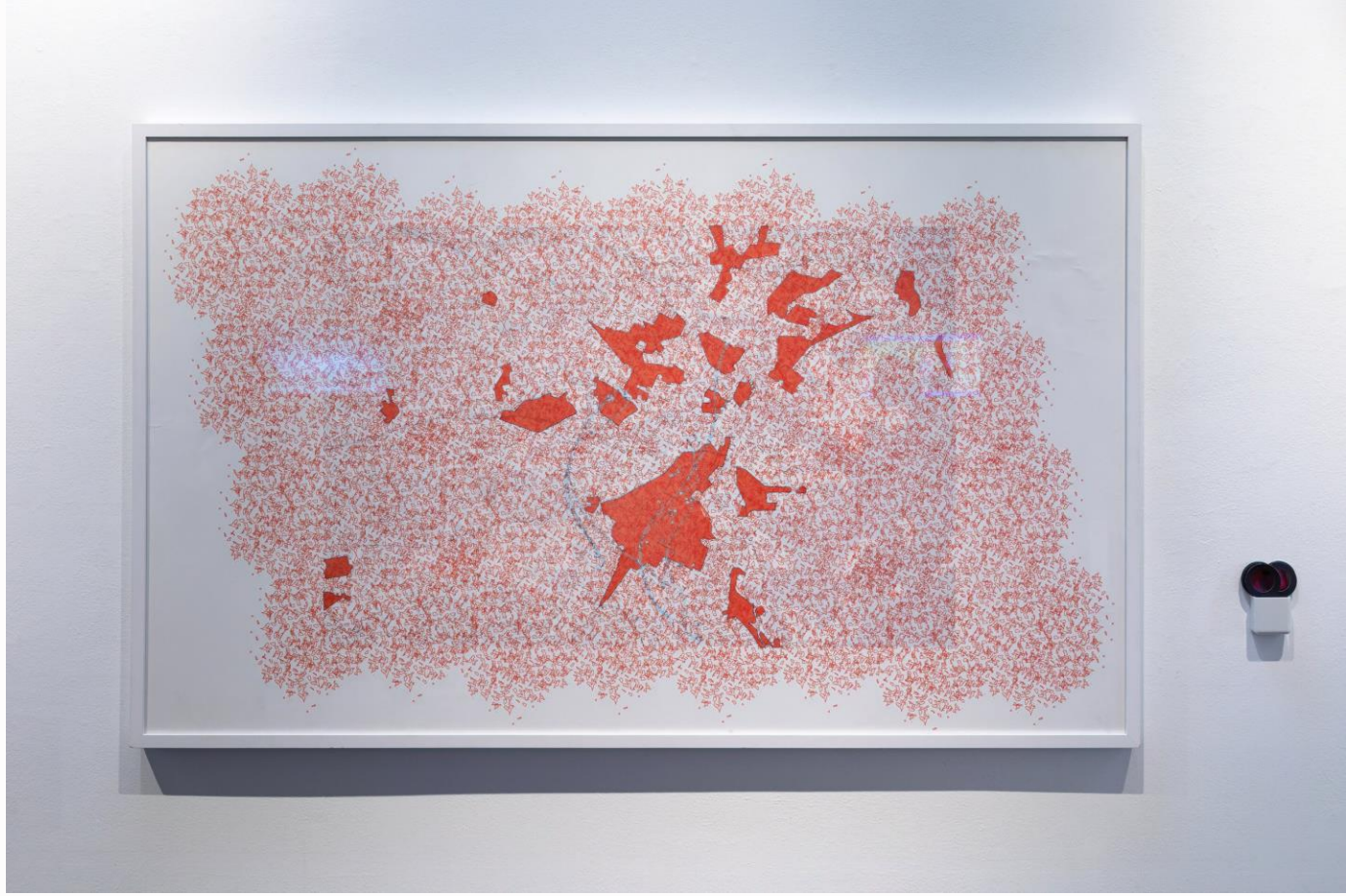
Critical and Feminist Geography have challenged critiqued map's objectivity:

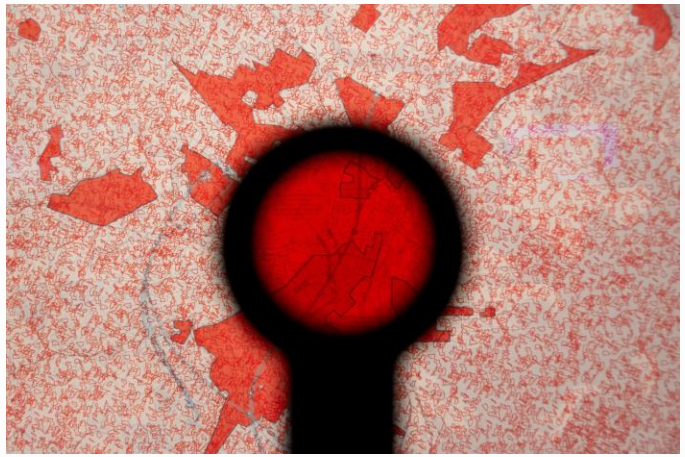
- Flagging (unconscious) bias by map-makers (usually men) (Monk & Hanson, 1982)
- Challenging positivist approaches and based exclusively in quantification (Barnes 2009; Smith 1979)
- Importance on what is being presented and silenced (Kwan, 2002; Pavlovskaya, 2009; D'Ignazio & Klein, 2016)
- More than representations: cultural expressions (Turnbull & Watson, 1989)

Maps, people, counterpower

Rise of **Volunteered Geographic Information** (Goodchild, 2007) as an opportunity

- No longer for/by elite: Anyone can create their own maps
- Opportunity to include a myriad of different worldviews
- Resulting maps could be more equitable (Goodchild, 2009) and tools for counter-power and resistance (Krupar, 2015)







Decoding Possibilities. Stereoscopic map displaying the effects of red lining on black population. Romi Morison